



DCIT208 IA2 - Client Interview Evidence and Requirement Transformation
Memo

Software Engineering

DCIT 208

22371334

Assignment 2

I used AI assistance. I used chatGPT, to help me organize my word well and the API, output was accepted and very helpful. I understand that I must be able to explain and defend every part of this submission.

JASKON-Tech

https://github.com/sarkodieshanell/personal_portfolio.git

<https://github.com/Dept-of-Comp-Sci-University-of-Ghana/dcit208-client-project-2026-team-engineering-repository-seg26-44-jaskon-tech.git>

ArchiVerse — A Centralized Project Tracking and Client Engagement System for Asamoah
Welbeck & Associates.

Sarkodie Shanell

2nd July, 2026

Personal Question Set

The following questions were prepared before the client interview to better understand the client's current workflow, challenges, data requirements, success criteria, security concerns, and possible system failures.

Current Workflow

- How do you currently manage architectural projects and communicate progress to your clients?
- What steps do you normally follow from the time a client contacts your company until the project is completed?

Pain Points

- What are the biggest challenges you face when managing multiple projects at the same time?
- Which parts of your current workflow consume the most time or cause the most frustration?

Data Requirements

- What information do you collect from clients before starting a project?
- What project documents or files do you need the system to store and manage?

Success Criteria

- What features would make this system successful for your business?
- How would you know that the new system has improved the way you manage projects?

Security and Privacy

- What information should only be accessible to authorized users, and how important is protecting client data?

Failure and Exception Handling

- What should happen if a client uploads an incorrect blueprint or the upload fails due to a network problem?

Additional Question

- Is there anything about your current process that you would definitely want the new system to improve or replace?

Interview or Observation Evidence

My group (JASKON-Tech) had a meeting with our client the CEO of the company we are working for Asamoah Welbeck and Associates. The meeting was held on the second of July at 10am at the Law School in the University of Ghana. I am the database administrator for y group so I asked our client a few question on who he wanted the system to work in relation to database. I asked our client how he assigns projects to his staff and he told me he sends it via email. I also asked him if records of previous clients are kept. He told me the physical files are stored in a store room. He although told me they have a system they back all the information of clients, and financial statement of the company. We finally asked him how he wants the system to be like and he said we should do “us” and he believe in us. So we suggested we would create a demo and send it to him so he could review it and if there are any changes or additions to make he’ll let us know. We had a good time, he was very nice and encouraging.

Requirement Transformation

Client raw statement: “We want to keep all our project information in one place so that architects can easily find and update project details.”

Functional requirement: The system shall allow authorized users to create, view, edit, and update project records.

Non-functional requirement: The system shall display project records within 5 seconds for up to 500-800 active projects.

User story: As an architect, I want to view and update project information so that I can keep project records accurate and up to date.

Acceptance criteria:

- Users with the Architect role can create new project records.
- Unauthorized users cannot modify project information.
- Users can edit project details and save changes successfully.

API/Interface Implication.

Provide an API endpoint such as GET /projects to retrieve project information and PUT /projects/{id} to update an existing project.

Data Implication

Create a **Projects** table containing fields such as ProjectID, ProjectName, ClientID, Location, StartDate, EndDate, Status, Budget, and AssignedArchitectID.

Test Idea: Verify that an authorized architect can update a project's status and that the updated information is correctly saved and displayed when the project is viewed again.

Open Question: Should the system keep an audit trail of all changes made to project records, including who made each change and when?

Reflection

Before speaking with the client, I assumed that developing the system would mainly involve designing and building features that we believed the architectural firm would need. I thought it was acceptable to create the system based on our own ideas and then present it to the client, who would either accept it or request changes afterward. Because of this assumption, I underestimated the importance of gathering detailed requirements before beginning development.

After interviewing the client, my understanding changed significantly. I realized that the success of a software system depends on understanding the client's actual business processes, challenges, and expectations. During the discussion, the client explained how they manage projects, client information, employee assignments, and project documents. This helped me see that every organization has unique workflows that cannot simply be guessed by developers. Asking questions also revealed requirements that we would not have factored in on our own, such as user roles, data security and reporting needs.

The assumption that became weaker was my belief that gathering information from the client was unnecessary. I now understand that requirements gathering is one of the most important stages of system development because it reduces misunderstandings and ensures that the final product meets the client's needs. Without interviewing the client, there is a high risk of developing features that are unnecessary while overlooking critical functionality that the client expects.

As the Database Administrator for the group, this experience also showed me the importance of collecting accurate information before designing the database. The interview helped identify the data that needs to be stored, the relationships between different types of information, and the security requirements for the system. Overall, the conversation demonstrated that effective communication with the client is essential for building a system that is useful, reliable, and aligned with the organization's goals.